

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

contract.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 7

Needing two more winners you will have to make both the ♠K and ♠Q. This will only be possible if East holds the ♠A. Win the first trick (if you don't East might switch to ♣s) and play a small ♠ toward dummy's ♠Q. It holds the trick.

You should take your four ♦ winners now, being sure to end up in your hand. Then play another small ♠ toward dummy's ♠K. This also wins.

You have now won 7 tricks so don't mess around now. Take your two Aces and let them have the last four tricks.

If West held the ♠A you would not have made the

A Simple Finesse has only a 50% success rate. That's why we only take finesses as a last resort.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 6
 ♥ A K Q J 4
 ♦ A 7 4
 ♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2
 ♥ 7 5 3
 ♦ Q 10
 ♣ K Q 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 7
 ♥ 10 6
 ♦ 9 8 5 2
 ♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ K J 6 3
 ♣ J 9 7

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♦ 3			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♦ 3.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=5 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 8

You need just one more winner. Since South probably has 4 ♦s you will not be able to establish a trick in that suit, so your only hope is the ♠Q. You win the first ♦ so they don't get a chance to switch to ♣s, a suit you are worse off in. Then take your 5 ♥ tricks, ending in dummy.

You can't put it off any longer so play a small ♠ from dummy and put the ♠Q on. If it wins you will make your contract, if it loses you won't.

North held the ♠K so you were lucky this time.

But remember, finesses only work half the time. The other half they lose.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 7
 ♥ Q J 10 9
 ♦ J 7 4
 ♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2



♠ Q J 9 4

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥Q			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=4 Total = 8

Needing one more winner you should see right away that it cannot come from ♥s, ♦s, or ♣s. That means you must hope that East has the ♠A. Win the first ♥, then play your 4 ♣ winners ending in dummy.

The moment of truth. You lead a small ♠ from dummy. East plays low and you play the ♠K.

Unfortunately West takes your ♠K with the ♠A. He then plays another ♥ and you at least make 8 tricks but have no hope for a ninth one so you go down 1.

You probably thought since these Deals were all about finesses that they would work all of the time.

Welcome to the real world.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 4
 ♥ K Q J 9 7 5
 ♦ 8
 ♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
 ♥ 10
 ♦ K 10 6 5
 ♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ 8 4 3 2
 ♦ A Q 7 4
 ♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ J 9 3 2
 ♣ A 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♠K			

hand. So you start pulling trumps and establishing the ♣s.

If the ♦ finesse had lost you would have gone down 2 instead of just one.

The risk was worthwhile though since it gave you your only chance of making the contract.

West is to play 4♥. North leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 4

North found the best opening lead for his side, exposing your ♠ losers before you could establish the ♣ suit for a discard. If you start to pull trumps right away the defense will grab the ♥A, then take their two ♠ tricks and you will still have the ♣A that you cannot avoid.

Other than the ♦A the only useful card in dummy is the ♦Q so you must try to make a winner out of that for a discard. So win the ♠A, lead your singleton ♦ and finesse the ♦Q. Your luck has returned, the ♦Q wins and you discard one of your ♠ losers on the ♦A.

At this point you have not lost any tricks, and you can see that you have only 3 losers remaining in your

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 3			

success depends on West holding a specific card, the ♥K.

The double ♣ finesse is much better because its success depends on East holding either of two cards, the ♣Q **OR** the ♣K.

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♠3.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=1 ♦=5 ♣=1 Total = 11

You need one more winner from the ♥ or ♣ suit. The straight finesse of the ♥K offers a 50% chance of success. The double finesse of the ♣ K Q offers a 75% chance of success. It's a no-brainer. Run 4 ♠s and 5 ♦s ending in your hand. Be very careful not to discard a ♣ from your hand.

Lead a small ♣ and play the ♣10 if East plays low. Let's say West wins the ♣K and returns a ♥.

DO NOT FINESSE THE ♥. Stick with your original 75% plan. Take the ♥A and play your small ♣, finessing the ♣J. This is why you couldn't discard a ♣ earlier.

The single ♥ finesse is an inferior play because its

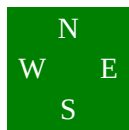
Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 4 3
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ A 6 5 3
 ♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K 9 6 4
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
 ♥ A Q J
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
 ♥ 10 8 3
 ♦ K Q J 10 7
 ♣ 8 4 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♦K			

East is to play 4♠. South leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

South has made another great lead. Any other suit would have given you a free finesse. You should duck the first ♦. It is very possible that South has led from ♦K Q 10 and will be afraid to continue for fear you have the ♦J in your hand. You'd be very happy to see him switch to any other suit. But he doesn't, he continues with the ♦Q which you take with dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy for the first, last, and only time. You need to try a finesse right now, but which one? At first you might think it makes no difference but, in fact, there is only one reasonable choice. If you finesse the ♠K successfully you may still have a ♠ loser. If you finesse the ♥K successfully you will surely still have a ♥ loser. But if you finesse the ♣K successfully you will eliminate your ♣ loser.

What a great layout! Three possible finesses and every one of them would work.

But as you can see, only the ♣ finesse will actually save you a trick.

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 6
♥ A K Q J 4
♦ A 7 4
♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10
♣ K Q 10 5



♠ A Q 7
♥ 10 6
♦ 9 8 5 2
♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3
♥ 9 8 2
♦ K J 6 3
♣ J 9 7

Board 9

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2



♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2

Board 13

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 10 9 5
♥ 7 5 2
♦ 8 6 4
♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4
♥ A K 3
♦ K J 10 2
♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2
♥ Q J 10 8
♦ 9 5
♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3
♥ 9 6 4
♦ A Q 7 3
♣ 6 4 2

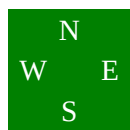
Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 6
♥ A K Q J 4
♦ A 7 4
♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10
♣ K Q 10 5



♠ A Q 7
♥ 10 6
♦ 9 8 5 2
♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3
♥ 9 8 2
♦ K J 6 3
♣ J 9 7

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

N
W E
S

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3

N
W E
 S

♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 8 6

♥ A K Q J 4

♦ A 7 4

♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10

♣ K Q 10 5



♠ A Q 7

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 5 2

♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 9 8 2

♦ K J 6 3

♣ J 9 7

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

N
W E
S

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 8 6

♥ A K Q J 4

♦ A 7 4

♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10

♣ K Q 10 5



♠ A Q 7

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 5 2

♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 9 8 2

♦ K J 6 3

♣ J 9 7

Board 27

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2



♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

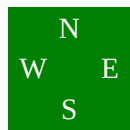
Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 8 6
♥ A K Q J 4
♦ A 7 4
♣ A 2

♠ K J 5 2
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10
♣ K Q 10 5



♠ A Q 7
♥ 10 6
♦ 9 8 5 2
♣ 8 6 4 3

♠ 10 4 3
♥ 9 8 2
♦ K J 6 3
♣ J 9 7

Board 33

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2



♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2